

Brainstorming Session Results

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Session Overview

Topic: AI-powered conversational recommendation engine for an all-in-one architecture & home solutions e-commerce platform serving architecture designers and high-end homeowners.

Goals: - Conversational Discovery — AI agent (chat/voice) that uncovers what customers truly need - Dynamic Persona Building — Construct customer profiles in real-time from discovery conversations - Persona-Driven Recommendations — Serve products based on the built persona - Continuous Persona Refinement — Evolve personas based on recommendation feedback loops - Long-Term Memory — Remember individual customer preferences across sessions

Session Setup

Platform covers: furniture, shower equipment, kitchen equipment, home products, building materials, electrical, design services, and parking solutions. Target audience includes architecture designers and high-end homeowners. The system should feel like a casual conversation that naturally surfaces customer needs and preferences.

Technique Selection

Approach: AI-Recommended Techniques **Analysis Context:** AI recommendation engine for architecture platform with focus on conversational discovery, persona building, and long-term memory

Recommended Techniques:

- **Role Playing:** Embody different customer archetypes (architects, homeowners) to build deep empathy and understand how each type discovers and articulates needs
- **Cross-Pollination:** Transfer winning patterns from other industries (Spotify, personal shopping, interior design consultations) into the recommendation engine design
- **Morphological Analysis:** Systematically map all system parameters (conversation modes, persona dimensions, product categories, feedback mechanisms) and explore powerful combinations

AI Rationale: Complex multi-stakeholder system requiring empathy-first understanding, creative mechanism borrowing, and systematic parameter exploration

Technique Execution Results

Role Playing — Consumer Homeowner Archetype

Interactive Focus: First-time homeowner who is excited but overwhelmed, lacks design vocabulary, and knows what they don't want more easily than what they do want.

Key Breakthroughs: - Customers cannot articulate preferences in design language — the system must never require it - Elimination (rejection) is cognitively easier than selection — flip the discovery model - Emotional state (excitement + anxiety) matters at first interaction — validate before asking - Speed-to-value is critical — too long in discovery mode and customers bounce - The persona itself is the retention hook — “we remember you” is the reason to return

Ideas Generated: - #1 Elimination-First Discovery - #2 Vocabulary Gap Bridge - #3 Excitement-to-Anxiety Arc - #4 AI-Generated Style Archetypes - #5 Progressive Abstraction Funnel - #6 Mood Board from Existing Catalog - #7 Separate Architect vs Consumer Modules - #8 Speed-to-Value Threshold - #9 Persona-as-Retention-Hook - #10 Thin Persona □ Fast Recommendation □ Rich Persona Loop - #11 Taste Profile

Progress Bar - #12 Dual-Signal Discovery (Like + Dislike) - #13 Recommendation Confidence Tied to Profile Completeness - #14 Never-Full Taste Bar - #15 Diminishing Returns Curve

Cross-Pollination — 5 Industries

Domains Explored: Spotify, Stitch Fix, Netflix, Tinder, Luxury Retail (Personal Shopper)

Key Breakthroughs: - Spotify: Users have multiple taste modes — multi-faceted portfolio, not one flat profile - Stitch Fix: The return reason is more valuable than the purchase — rejection feedback is gold - Netflix: Same product, different framing based on persona — personalized presentation - Tinder: What people say they want ≠ what they actually choose — track both, weight dynamically - Luxury Retail: Digital body language (scroll speed, zoom, revisit) = the online salesperson's intuition

Ideas Generated: - #16 Multi-Faceted Taste Portfolio - #17 Facet Cross-Pollination Within the Customer - #18 2-Second Rejection Feedback (preset buttons) - #19 Contextual Preset Buttons (category-specific) - #20 Silent Skip vs Active Rejection - #21 Persona Archetypes with Personalized Showrooms - #22 Hybrid Archetype Blending - #23 Archetype as Content Strategy - #24 Say vs Do Persona Gap Detection - #25 Dynamic Trust Weighting — Words vs Actions - #26 Aspirational vs Actual Dual Feed - #27 Contradiction as Opportunity Signal - #28 Digital Body Language Reading

Morphological Analysis — System Parameter Mapping

Parameters Defined: | Parameter | Selected Direction | |—|—| | A. Discovery Input | Mixed (visual swipes + chat) | | B. Discovery Method | Dual-signal elimination (like + dislike) | | C. Persona Structure | Multi-faceted portfolio with archetype blending | | D. Signal Source | Combined weighted (stated □ behavioral shift) | | E. Presentation | Archetype showrooms + dual feed | | F. Feedback | Active 2-sec rejection buttons + passive behavioral | | G. Profile Visibility | Never-full taste bar | | H. Persona Evolution | Continuous + dynamic trust reweighting | | I. Matching Engine | Embedding similarity |

Key Intersection Explorations: - Rejection buttons × Embeddings: Each button tap maps to a precise vector operation pushing the persona away from the rejected product's embedding - Multi-faceted portfolio × Embeddings: Separate vectors per room facet, switchable during browsing - Embedding space × Persona evolution × Discovery input: All channels (swipes, behavior, conversation) feed the same vector space with different weights

Ideas Generated: - #29 Embedding-Based Persona-to-Product Matching - #30 Emergent Archetypes from Embedding Clusters - #31 Multi-Modal Embedding Generation - #32 Conversational Vector Steering - #33 Multi-Channel Vector Input Hierarchy - #34 Demand Gap Detection from Embedding Space

Idea Organization and Prioritization

Thematic Organization

Theme 1: Discovery UX — How Customers Reveal Their Taste - #1 Elimination-First Discovery - #2 Vocabulary Gap Bridge - #3 Excitement-to-Anxiety Arc - #5 Progressive Abstraction Funnel - #8 Speed-to-Value Threshold - #12 Dual-Signal Discovery

Theme 2: Persona Architecture — How the Profile Is Structured - #16 Multi-Faceted Taste Portfolio - #17 Facet Cross-Pollination - #21 Persona Archetypes (8-15 clusters) - #22 Hybrid Archetype Blending - #24 Say vs Do Gap Detection - #25 Dynamic Trust Weighting - #30 Emergent Archetypes from Embedding Clusters

Theme 3: Feedback Loops — How the System Keeps Learning - #10 Thin Persona □ Fast Recommendation □ Rich Persona Loop - #18 2-Second Rejection Feedback - #19 Contextual Preset Buttons - #20 Silent Skip vs Active Rejection - #26 Aspirational vs Actual Dual Feed - #28 Digital Body Language

Theme 4: Matching Engine — How Persona Becomes Product - #29 Embedding-Based Matching - #31 Multi-Modal Embedding Generation - #32 Conversational Vector Steering - #33 Multi-Channel Vector Input Hierarchy - #27 Contradiction as Opportunity Signal

Theme 5: Presentation & Retention — How Products Are Shown - #4 AI-Generated Style Archetypes - #6 Mood Board from Existing Catalog - #9 Persona-as-Retention-Hook - #11/14/15 Taste Profile Bar (never full, diminishing returns) - #13 Recommendation Confidence Language - #23 Archetype as Content Strategy

Theme 6: Business Intelligence - #7 Separate Architect vs Consumer Modules - #34 Demand Gap Detection

Prioritization Results

Top 3 Highest-Impact Ideas: 1. **#29 Embedding-Based Matching** — Technical foundation; everything depends on this 2. **#10 Thin Persona** □ **Fast Recommendation** □ **Rich Persona Loop** — Core product loop; keeps users engaged 3. **#1 Elimination-First Discovery** — UX differentiator at the front door

Quick Wins: 1. **#18 2-Second Rejection Feedback Buttons** — Simple UI, massive data value 2. **#11/14 Taste Profile Bar** — Straightforward frontend, immediate gamification 3. **#6 Mood Board from Existing Catalog** — No new assets needed

Most Innovative (Competitive Edge): 1. **#32 Conversational Vector Steering** — Chat as direct mathematical interface to recommendations 2. **#34 Demand Gap Detection** — Recommendation engine informs procurement 3. **#24/25 Say vs Do Gap with Dynamic Trust Weighting** — Sophisticated preference modeling

Recommended Build Sequence

Phase	What to Build	Why This Order
Phase 1: Foundation	Embedding engine (#29, #31) + catalog vectorization	Nothing works without this
Phase 2: MVP Discovery	Elimination swipes (#1, #12) + thin persona loop (#10) + first recommendations	Proves concept end-to-end
Phase 3: Feedback Layer	Rejection buttons (#18, #19) + behavioral signals (#20, #28)	Starts the learning flywheel
Phase 4: Engagement	Taste bar (#14, #15) + confidence language (#13)	Retention and gamification
Phase 5: Intelligence	Conversational steering (#32) + archetype emergence (#30) + demand gaps (#34)	Advanced differentiation

Session Summary and Insights

Key Achievements: - 34 ideas generated across 6 themes from 3 creativity techniques - Clear technical architecture emerged (embedding-based, multi-faceted personas) - Practical build sequence defined from foundation to advanced features - Core UX philosophy established: elimination over articulation, speed over completeness

Breakthrough Concepts: - The customer's inability to describe what they want is not a problem to solve — it's the design constraint to embrace (elimination-first) - The recommendation engine and chat agent are not separate features — they're one system operating in the same vector space - The taste profile bar is simultaneously a UX element, a gamification tool, and a retention mechanism - The same system that serves customers also informs business procurement decisions

Design Principles Emerged: 1. Never require design vocabulary from consumers 2. Recommend within 60-90 seconds — speed-to-value above all 3. Every interaction is a persona signal — nothing is wasted 4. The persona is multi-faceted, evolving, and never “complete” 5. Stated preferences and behavioral signals are both valid but weighted differently over time